

audacity.sourceforge.net, along with MP3 format software lame_enc.dll. Once the downloading is complete, unzip the lame files and save in the Audacity folder.

To start Audacity, press Control P (Ctrl+P) to get 'Preferences' dialogue box. Select 'File Format' tab and find 'Library'. Click the lame_enc.dll file, followed by 'OK.' Then select 192 kbits/sec in 'MP3 Export' setup and click 'Audio I/O' tab. Make sure that the 'Software Play Through' option is ticked. Save the file by clicking 'OK.' The Audacity software is now ready for use from the icon on the desktop.

Hardware requirements

To copy the music from audio cassettes, you require a good-quality stereo tape recorder and a connecting audio cable. The audio output from the tape recorder can be obtained from the headphone (phono) socket or auxiliary output. These outputs give audio from the preamplifier stage, so the audio is clear without much distortion. The audio cable is used to connect the headphone socket of the tape recorder to line-in socket (blue-coloured) of the computer. Use a moulded audio cable with suitable jacks at the ends.

Soundcard optimisation

Before recording, optimise the soundcard setup of the PC. Open the soundcard's 'Volume Setup' by clicking Start → All Programmes → Accessories → Entertainment → Volume Control. Set the volume of recording to maximum. In Windows XP, click Start → Settings → Control Panel → Sounds and Audio Devices. Select 'Audio' tab and click 'Volume.' Adjust the volume tab to 75 per cent. Select microphone as the default device. Click 'Volume,' set the recording volume tab to the middle position and click 'OK.' Check whether the box 'Use Only Default Devices' is ticked.

In most of the sound cards' recording setup, the line-in input is kept as



Fig. 1: Audacity frame with stereo waveform



Fig. 2 Hardware required for recording



Fig. 3: PC sound card

round sound. If so, change it to 'line-in' using 'Advanced Setup.'

Connecting the tape recorder to the PC

Using the audio cable, connect the headphone socket of the tape recorder to the line-in socket (blue) of the PC. Open the Audacity frame by clicking the icon on the desktop. Select 'Line-in Socket' as the input in the frame. Then select 'Monitor Input' from the dropdown box below the symbol of mic. This helps to hear the recording music through PC speakers. Adjust the microphone slider

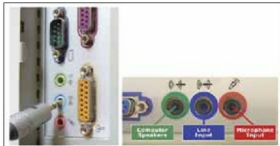


Fig. 4: Connecting the cassette recorder to line-in of the sound card

default. In that case, do not change the settings. In some systems, the line-in socket is kept as 'output' for the sur-

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